# ITC327W: Work Integrated Learning

## Phase 1 Portfolio

**Project Title:** Big Brother Student Accommodation Management System

**Stakeholder:** Mr Ngubane

**Organisation:** Big Brother Student Accommodations

**Group Member:**

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**Submission Date:** 31/08/2026

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# 1. INTRODUCTION

## 1.1 Purpose of the Project

Big Brother Student Accommodation currently experiences difficulties in advertising accommodation, sharing accommodation information, managing student applications, and maintaining accommodation records. Most processes are handled manually and rely heavily on word-of-mouth communication, WhatsApp groups, and referrals. The purpose of this project is to develop an integrated accommodation management solution that improves access to accommodation information, simplifies applications and bookings, and assists management in monitoring accommodation operations.

## 1.2 Proposed Solution

The proposed solution consists of:

- Flutter Mobile Application
- ASP.NET Web Application
- Shared Supabase Backend

The two applications will share information through a centralized Supabase database, ensuring data consistency between students and accommodation management.

# 2. STAKEHOLDER PROFILE

## 2.1 Organisation Information

| ITEM | DETAILS |
|---|---|
| Business Name | Big Brother Student Accomodations |
| Stakeholder | Mr Ngubane |
| Business Type | Student Accommodation Provider |
| Location | Universtas, Bloemfontein |
| Primary Users | Management |
| Secondary Users | Student and Prospective Tenants |

Information obtained from stakeholder interviews indicates that the organisation provides NSFAS-accredited accommodation mainly for UFS and CUT students. Shuttle services are also available. The organisation relies heavily on referrals, WhatsApp groups, current students, and taxi association for advertising.

# 3. CURRENT PROCESS ANALYSIS

## 3.1 Current Process Description

The current accommodation process operates as follows:

1. Big Brother Student Accommodations advertises its accommodation through word of mouth, WhatsApp groups, current students living there, group administrators of the shuttle service taking students to their hometowns when schools close.

2. Prospective students make enquiries through these informal communication channels.

3. Students are encouraged to visit the accommodation in person for a viewing.

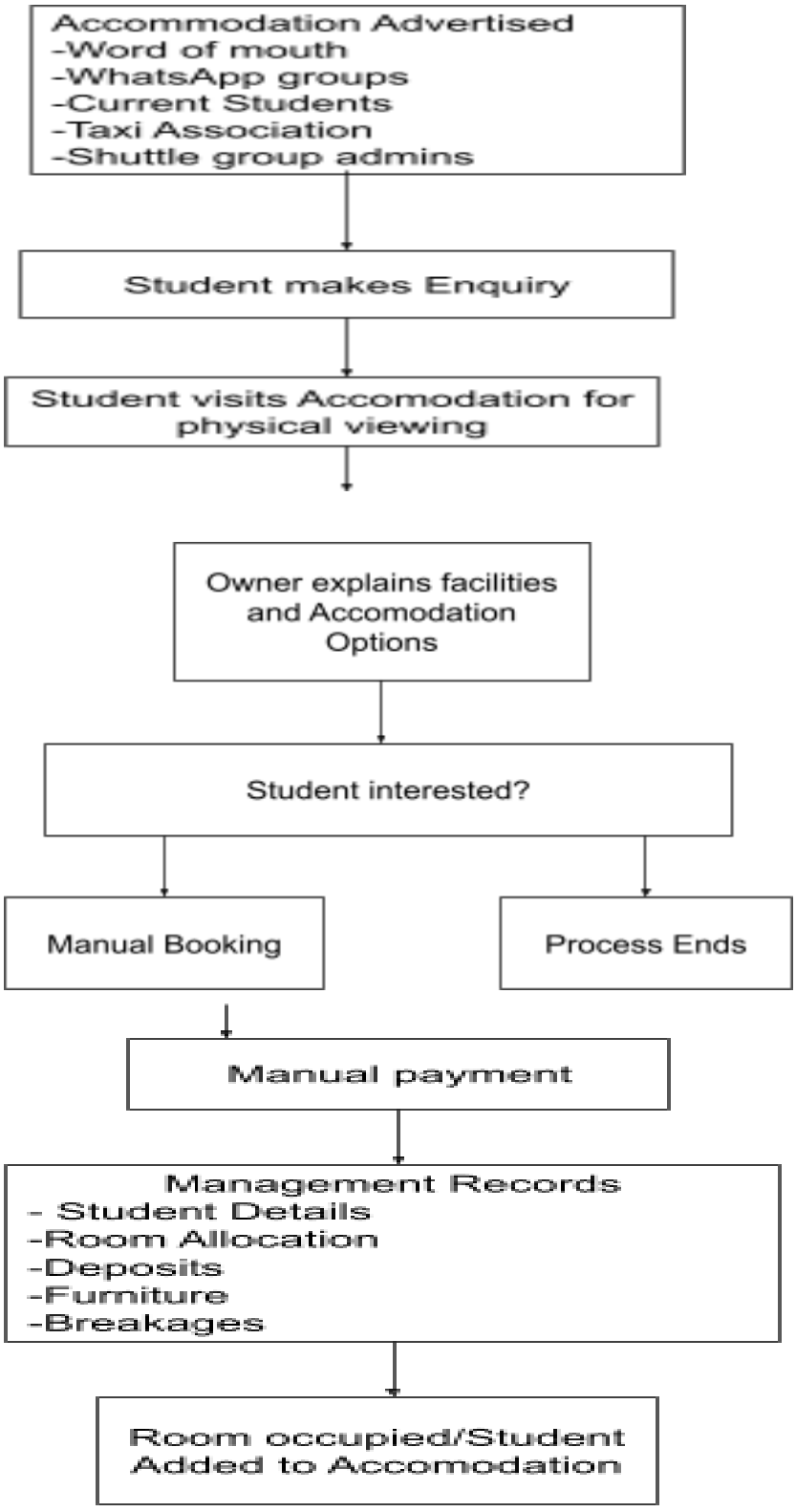
4. During the viewing, the owner explains the available facilities and accommodation arrangements.

5. The student decides whether the accommodation is suitable.

6. Bookings and payments are currently handled manually because the organisation does not have a formal management system.

7. Management keeps information such as available units, room furniture, student details, deposits, and breakages manually.

## 3.2 Current Process Flow Diagram



## 3.3 People Involved

- **Accommodation owner and management**: Advertises the accommodation, explains the facilities, manages student information, and controls applications and bookings.
- **Current students living there**: Help advertise the accommodation to prospective tenants.
- **Taxi association shuttle organisers**: Help promote the accommodation to students travelling to the university at the start of each academic year.
- **Shuttle group administrators**: Share accommodation information with potential tenants.
- **Prospective tenants**: View the accommodation, submit their details, apply, and make booking decisions.

# 4. PROBLEM ANALYSIS

## 4.1 Problem Statement

Big Brother Student Accommodations currently relies on informal advertising methods such as word of mouth, WhatsApp groups, and taxi association promotion. Prospective students generally need to visit the accommodation physically to view the rooms and receive information. Bookings and payments are also managed manually because the organisation does not have a central management system. This process makes it difficult for the organisation to reach enough prospective students, share accurate accommodation information, manage applications, and monitor available units. The stakeholder also reported concerns about first-year students being targeted by people falsely claiming to assist with accommodation arrangements. Management does not currently have a central system for managing student information, deposits, room occupancy, furniture, and breakages.

## 4.2 Consequences

The current process may result in:

- Limited reach to prospective tenants
- Difficulty sharing accommodation information
- Delays in managing applications and bookings
- Inconsistent or incomplete records
- Difficulty tracking room availability and student occupancy
- Increased exposure of students to accommodation scams
- A possible threat to the organisation’s business continuity

## 4.3 Need for Improvement

The organisation needs a centralised system that makes accommodation information easier to access, allows prospective tenants to view availability and apply, and helps management control, monitor, and respond to student information. The system should also protect student information and support more effective marketing of the accommodation.

# 5. PROJECT AIM AND OBJECTIVES

## 5.1 Overall Purpose

To develop an integrated software prototype that digitises and streamlines the management operations of Big Brother Student Accommodation, improving student sourcing, application processing, and operational efficiency.

## 5.2 Specific Objectives

| Objective | Action |
|---|---|
| 1. Digital application platform | Enable students to upload particulars and apply through the system |
| 2. Accommodation viewing | Allow students to view accommodations, check availability, and make bookings |
| 3. Centralised management | Enable management to control, monitor, and manage data |
| 4. Information sharing | Allow easy sharing of business information to prospective tenants |
| 5. Security | Secure student information and ensure it is not accessible by unauthorised persons |
| 6. Application tracking | Allow students to check status updates accordingly |
| 7. Data analysis | Enable management to access, analyse, and respond to student information |
| 8. Student self-service | Allow students to view, add, and change their information |
| 9. Business visibility | Allow students to understand vision, values, and mission of the organisation |
| 10. Payment system | Implement payment functionality |
| 11. Feedback mechanism | Collect reviews, comments, and areas of improvement from students |
| 12. Unit management | Track units available, furniture, occupant details, deposits, and breakages |

# 6. PROJECT SCOPE

## 6.1 Deliverables

- Flutter mobile application for the management and students
- ASP.NET web application for management
- Supabase shared backend and database
- Integrated solution where both applications access the same data
- Technical documentation
- User guides where applicable

## 6.2 Acceptance Criteria

- Management can view and manage student applications
- Management can control, monitor, and manage data
- Management can access, analyse, and respond to student information
- Management can view accommodation listings and occupant details
- Students can upload particulars and apply on the system
- Students can view accommodations, check availability, and make bookings
- Students can view, add, and change their information (with management approval)
- Students can submit reviews, comments, and recommendations
- Student information is secured and not accessible by unauthorised persons
- All information is consistent across mobile and web applications
- System is functional for demonstration purposes

## 6.3 Exclusions

- Full payment processing integration (e.g., automated EFT reconciliation)
- Advanced reporting and analytics dashboards
- Integration with external systems (e.g., banking APIs, municipal systems)
- Full production deployment and hosting
- Professional security audit and penetration testing
- Mobile app store publication
- Multi-property support (limited Big Brother Student Accommodation)

## 6.4 Project Constraints

- Development must be completed within one academic semester
- Limited budget (student project)
- Technology stack is predetermined: Flutter, ASP.NET, Supabase
- Team comprises students with developing skills
- Stakeholder may not always be available for feedback and students may not always be accessible for testing

## 6.5 Project Assumptions

- Stakeholder will be available for requirements gathering, feedback, and evaluation
- Student users will be accessible for feedback and testing
- Supabase will provide sufficient functionality for the project scope
- The approved prototype does not need to be production-ready
- All development work will be managed through GitHub
- Microsoft Project will be used for project scheduling

# 7. STAKEHOLDER NEEDS

- Students should be able to upload their particulars and apply on the system
- Students should be able to view accommodations, check availability, apply, and make bookings
- Students should be able to check status updates
- Management should be able to control, monitor, and manage data
- Management should be able to access, analyse, and respond to information
- Prospective tenants should be able to use the application

- Management should be able to use the application
- Students should be able to view the entire processes and business model
- Students should understand the vision, values, and mission of the organisation
- Student information should be secured and not accessible by unauthorised persons
- Easy access to information and application for accommodation
- Payment system should be included
- Students should be able to view, add, and change their information (with management approval)
- Management should be able to view accommodation listings and occupant details
- System should provide summary of students visiting page and viewing accommodation
- System should collect reviews, comments, and areas of improvement from students
- System should track units available, furniture, occupant details, deposits, and breakages

# 8. FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

1. FR1 System shall allow students to create accounts and upload their particulars
2. FR2 System shall allow students to submit accommodation applications
3. FR3 System shall allow students to view available accommodations
4. FR4 System shall allow students to check availability and make bookings
5. FR5 System shall allow students to check application status updates
6. FR6 System shall allow management to control, monitor, and manage data
7. FR7 System shall allow management to access, analyse, and respond to student information
8. FR8 System shall display the entire application process and business model
9. FR9 System shall display the organisation's vision, values, and mission
10. FR11 System shall authenticate users (management and student roles)
11. FR12 System shall secure student information

13. FR13 System shall provide easy access to information and accommodation applications

14. FR14 System shall include payment functionality (Medium)

15. FR15 System shall allow students to view, add, and change their information

16. FR16 Management shall approve changes made by students

17. FR17 System shall allow management to view accommodation listings and occupant details

18. FR18 System shall provide summaries of students visiting the page and viewing accommodations

19. FR19 System shall collect reviews, comments, and areas of improvement from students

20. FR20 System shall track units available, furniture, occupant details, deposits, and breakages

# 9. NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

1. NFR1 Mobile application must be responsive for student use
2. NFR2 Web application must be accessible via standard web browsers
3. NFR3 System should have intuitive user interfaces requiring minimal training
4. NFR4 System must protect student personal information
5. NFR5 Authentication must separate management and student access levels
6. NFR6 Supabase database must be accessible to both Flutter and ASP.NET applications
7. NFR7 System must maintain data integrity across all platforms
8. NFR8 Source code must be organised and documented

## COULD HAVE REQUIREMENTS

| ID | Requirement | Description | Reason |
|---|---|---|---|
| C1 | Advanced Online Payment | Students could complete additional payment functions online. | Could improve convenience but requires additional implementation considerations. |
| C2 | Reviews and Ratings | Students could review and rate the accommodation. | Useful for future marketing and engagement. |
| C3 | Advanced Reports | Management could generate reports on applications, bookings and occupancy. | Useful for future business analysis. |
| C4 | Virtual Accommodation Tour | Students could view the virtual tours of accommodation facilities. | Could further reduce dependence on physical viewing. |
| C5 | Favorites | Students could save preferred accommodation listings. | Convenience feature that is not essential to the core system. |

# 10. INTEGRATION REQUIREMENTS

**How Flutter, ASP.NET and Supabase Will Operate as One Integrated Solution**

The proposed solution for Big Brother Student Accommodation will consist of three main components working together seamlessly: a Flutter mobile application, an ASP.NET web application, and a Supabase backend. These components will operate as one integrated system where all data is shared and synchronised in real-time.

Supabase Backend (Shared Database & Authentication):

Supabase will serve as the central backbone of the system, providing database, authentication, real-time subscriptions, row-level security, and API endpoints for both Flutter and ASP.NET applications to interact with.

### Flutter Mobile Application (Students & Management):

The Flutter mobile application will allow students to view accommodations, check availability, apply, make bookings, track application status, upload particulars, and submit reviews. Management will be able to view and manage applications, control data, monitor bookings, access analytics, manage units, and respond to students. Flutter will use the Supabase Dart client to connect directly to the Supabase backend, with all data retrieved and displayed in real-time.

### ASP.NET Web Application (Management):

The ASP.NET web application will provide management with a dashboard, student management, unit management, payment tracking, reporting, and data management capabilities.ASP.NET will connect to Supabase using the Supabase C# client or REST API, accessing the same database tables as the Flutter application.

# 11. FEASIBILITY STUDY

## Feasibility Study (Technical, Operational, Economic, Schedule, Legal, and Ethical feasibility studying)

The proposed student accommodation management system is feasible with minor changes, directly solving the stakeholder’s core operational, marketing, and scam-prevenation issues.

| Feasibility Area | What Must Be Evaluated |
|---|---|
| Technical feasibility | Highly feasible. The tech stack (Flutter for frontend, ASP.NET Core for backend APIs, Supabase for cloud database and authentication) directly supports all required capabilities, including online room viewing, application submissions, real-time availability tracking, and admin management portals. |
| Operational feasibility | Highly feasible. The application directly addresses critical pain points by modernizing their reliance on manual bookings and word-of-mouth marketing (points 2, 3 and 4 found under section: Stakeholder Needs). It eliminates distance barriers by providing remote viewing,<br>mitigates scam risks targeting first years (point 5 Stakeholder Needs), and streamlines how management tracks and responds to applications (point 9, 12 and 13 of Stakeholder needs ). |
| Economic feasibility | Feasible with scope control. Developing an open-source/low-tier backend (Supabase free tier) keeps costs near zero during the academic build phase. Budgeting focuses solely on developer time and free-tier infrastructure. |
| Schedule feasibility | Feasible with scope control. Building a full end to end payment gateway within a single academic semester poses schedule risks. To ensure delivery, the members should implement stimulated payment status updates for phase 1 rather than full bank/gateway integration. |
| Legal feasibility | Feasible. Handling prospective student personal information (IDs, proof of registration, contact details) requires strict adherence to privacy legislation, for example POPIA/GDPR. Secure data storage via Supabase with role based access control “RBAC” ensures compliant data handling. |
| Ethical feasibility | Highly feasible. Digitalizing the platform protects vulnerable first year students from accommodation scams (point 5: Stakeholder Needs) and creates a fair, transparent application process for all applicants regardless of their physical location. |

## Overall Feasibility Decision

Justification: The core system solves direct threats to the stakeholder's business survival. However, full operational features like live automated payment gateways and complex admin analytics should be scaled back to mock features/prototypes to maintain schedule and technical feasibility within the semester timeframe.

# 12. RISK REGISTER

## 12.1 Risk Register

| Risk ID | Risk statement | Category | Likelihood (1-3) | Impact (1-3) | Score | Level | Mitigation | Contingency | Owner | Status |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| R1 | Stakeholder may take too long to respond when feedback is needed on booking or approval | Stakeholder | 2 | 3 | 6 | Medium | Schedule meeting date and time in advance and confirm dates early | Use previously confirmed requirements and request written feedback | Person 1 | Open |
| R2 | Double-booking may occur if available check logic fails, which can lead to two students booking the same room | Technical | 3 | 3 | 9 | High | Test Supabase date overlap query early with 20 test bookings before full development | Allow admin to manually cancel duplicate booking via ASP.NET | Person 3 | Monitoring |
| R3 | Development task (booking, approval, maintenance and request) may take longer than planned | Schedule | 3 | 2 | 6 | Medium | Break tasks into 2-day tasks in MS Project and monitor weekly | Postpone lower priority funtions to project testing and demo time | Person 9 | Open |
| R4 | Limited Supabase experience may delay backend integration between Flutter and ASP.NET | Technical | 3 | 3 | 9 | High | Assign 2 members to do the Supabase tutorial | Simplify to one app integration first, then add second | Person 9 | Open |
| R5 | too many features (eg. online payments) | Scope | 2 | 3 | 6 | Medium | must,should and could have and confirm core scope with stakeholder early | Remove or postpone lower-priority | Person 3/4 | Open |
| R6 | Github merge conflicts may occur due to 10 members pushing the same repo | Team | 3 | 2 | 6 | Medium | Create branch per member and person 9 reviews pull requests | Revert to last stable main branch and re-apply changes | Person 9 | Open |
| R7 | A group member may not complete assigned task on time, delaying dependent activities | Team | 2 | 2 | 4 | Medium | Assign clear individual responsibilities and monitioring progress weekly via the progress tracker | Reassigning urgent tasks to available members and record the concern in the tracker | Person 10 | Open |
| R8 | Poor communication between group members may cause delays in task handover | Team | 3 | 2 | 6 | Medium | Schedule fixed meeting time (eg. every friday) have daily update on Whatsapp group chat and send reminders 24 hours before deadline | If member does not respond 2 members will be responsible for contact the member directly and record communication concern in progress | Person 10 | Open |

| | | | | | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | R9 | Real student personal information may be accidentally uploaded to Github | Data & Security | 1 | 3 | | Low | Use only fake test data, check commits before push | Immediately delete file purge history and replace with test data | Person 7 | Open |
| 11 | R10 | Limited testing time before the final demonstration could mean booking or approval bugs go unnoticed | Quality | 2 | 3 | 6 | Medium | Schedule dedicated testing time in the MS Project schedule separate from development time | Focus testing on core must-have function (booking and approval) before the demo | Person 8/9 | Open |
| 12 | | | | | | | | | | | |
| 13 | | | | | | | | | | | |

## 11.2 Top 3 Highest Risks

| | A | B | C |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | High Risk | Why is it important ? | What must the Group do now? |
| 2 | 1. R02 - Double-booking may occur if availability check logic fails | If availability logic fails,two studenst will be booked for the same room and the stakeholder will reject the prototype | Person 3 must test the Supabase date-overlap query early using 20 fake booking and share screenshot in group |
| 3 | 2. R04 Limited Supabase experience may delay backend integration between Flutter and ASP.NET | If Supabase integration fails, both Flutter mobile app and ASP.NET web app will not receive data and the whole project stops | Person 9 must complete Supabase tutorial in Week 1 and build a small test integration before full development |
| 4 | 3. R08 poor communicatuion between group members may cause delays in task handover | With 10 members, late replies on Whatsapp cause next member to wait, this delays dependent activities like ASP.NET admin approval depending on Flutter booking. It also affects MS Project Schedule and cause merge conflicts. | Person 10 to schedule weekly progress meetings every Friday, on teams or physically, enforce dailly updates on Whatsapp and send reminders on deadlines 24 hours before deadline |
| 5 | | | |
| 6 | | | |

# 13.WORK BREAKDOWN STRUCTURE (WBS)

## 1. Planning and Requirement Analysis

### 1.1 Stakeholder Identification

1.1.1 Identify stakeholder

1.1.2 Obtain stakeholder approval

1.1.3 Arrange stakeholder meeting

### 1.2 Stakeholder Engagement

1.2.1 Conduct stakeholder interview

1.2.2 Record interview responses

1.2.3 Collect communication evidence

### 1.3 Current Process Analysis

1.3.1 Analyse current accommodation process

1.3.2 Identify people involved

1.3.3 Develop current process flow diagram

### 1.4 Requirements Gathering

1.4.1 Gather stakeholder needs

1.4.2 Identify functional requirements

1.4.3 Identify non-functional requirements

1.4.4 Identify integration requirements

### 1.5 Software Requirements Specification

1.5.1 Compile SRS document

1.5.2 Review SRS

1.5.3 Finalise SRS

## 2. Feasibility Study

2.1 Technical Feasibility

2.2 Operational Feasibility

2.3 Economic Feasibility

2.4 Schedule Feasibility

2.5 Legal Feasibility

2.6 Ethical Feasibility

2.7 Feasibility Report Compilation

### 3. Risk Management

3.1 Risk Identification

3.2 Risk Analysis

3.3 Risk Register Development

3.4 Risk Mitigation Planning

### 4. Project Planning

4.1 Create Work Breakdown Structure

4.2 Develop Microsoft Project Schedule

4.3 Define Project Milestones

4.4 Establish Baseline Schedule

### 5. Project Setup

5.1 Create GitHub Repository

5.2 Add Team Members

5.3 Upload Initial Documentation

5.4 Create Supabase Project

5.5 Configure Database

5.6 Configure Authentication

### 6. Phase 1 Portfolio

6.1 Compile Stakeholder Analysis

6.2 Compile SRS

6.3 Compile Feasibility Study

6.4 Compile Risk Register

6.5 Gather Supporting Evidence

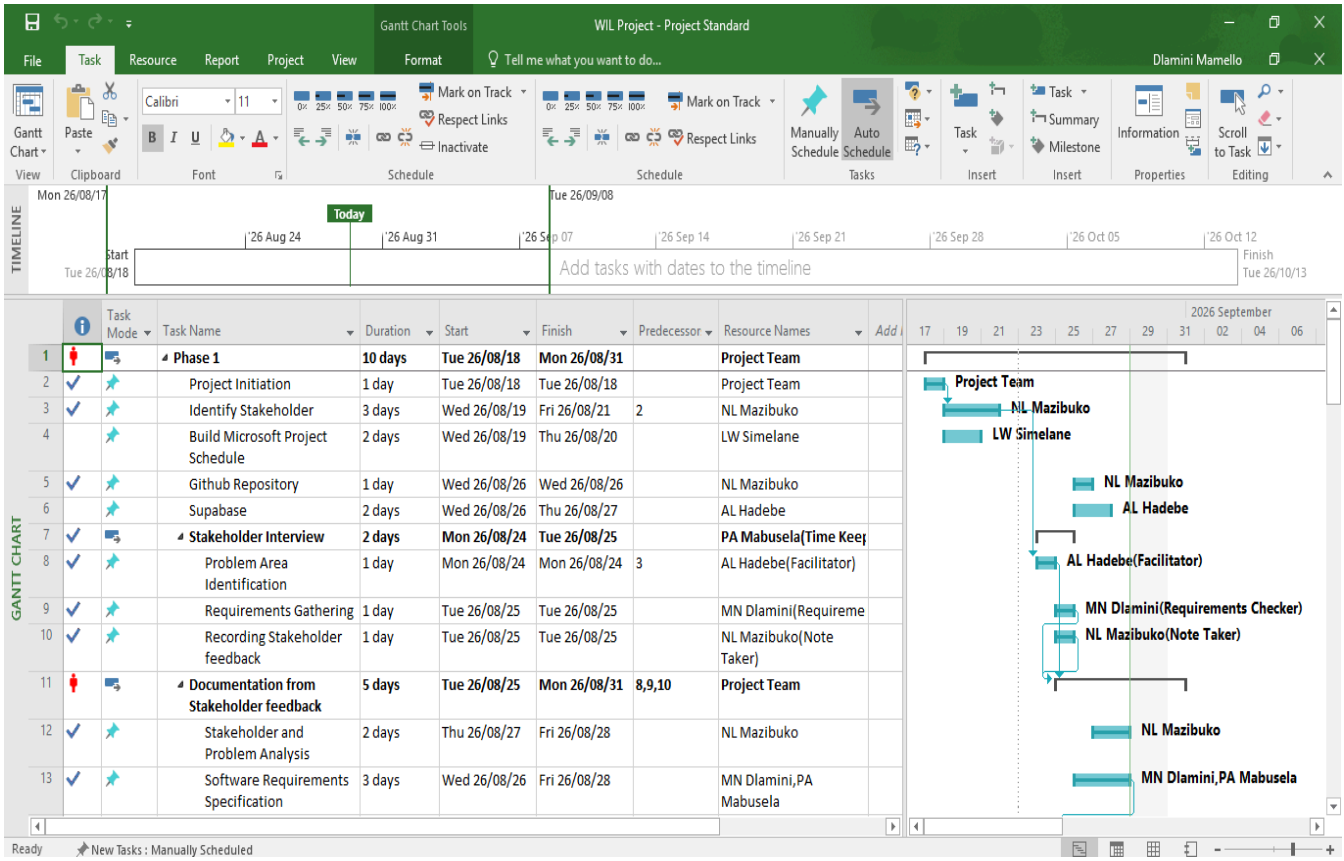
6.6 Complete Group Reflection

6.7 Final Submission

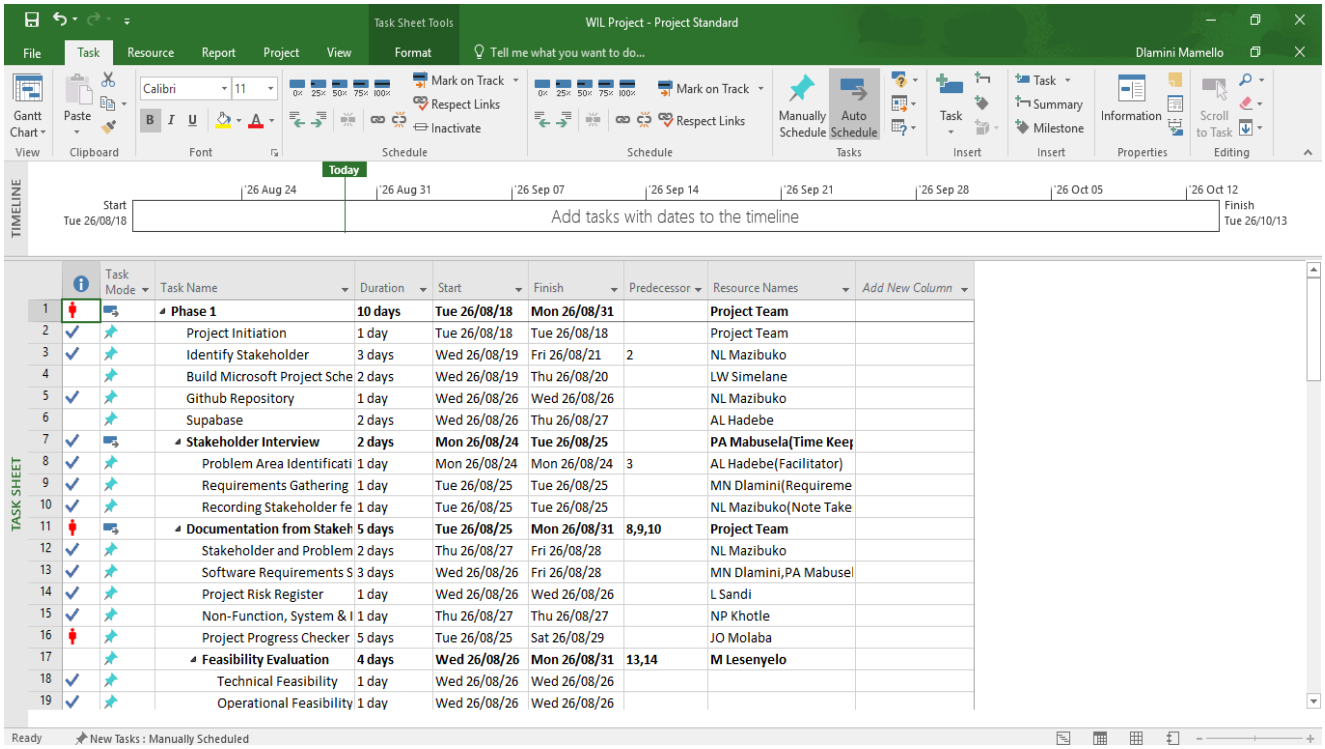
# 14. MICROSOFT PROJECT BASELINE

The project schedule is required to be developed and maintained using Microsoft Project to support project planning, task allocation, scheduling, tracking, and monitoring throughout the project lifecycle. The schedule will serve as the baseline against which project progress will be measured

### 14.1 Gantt chart:



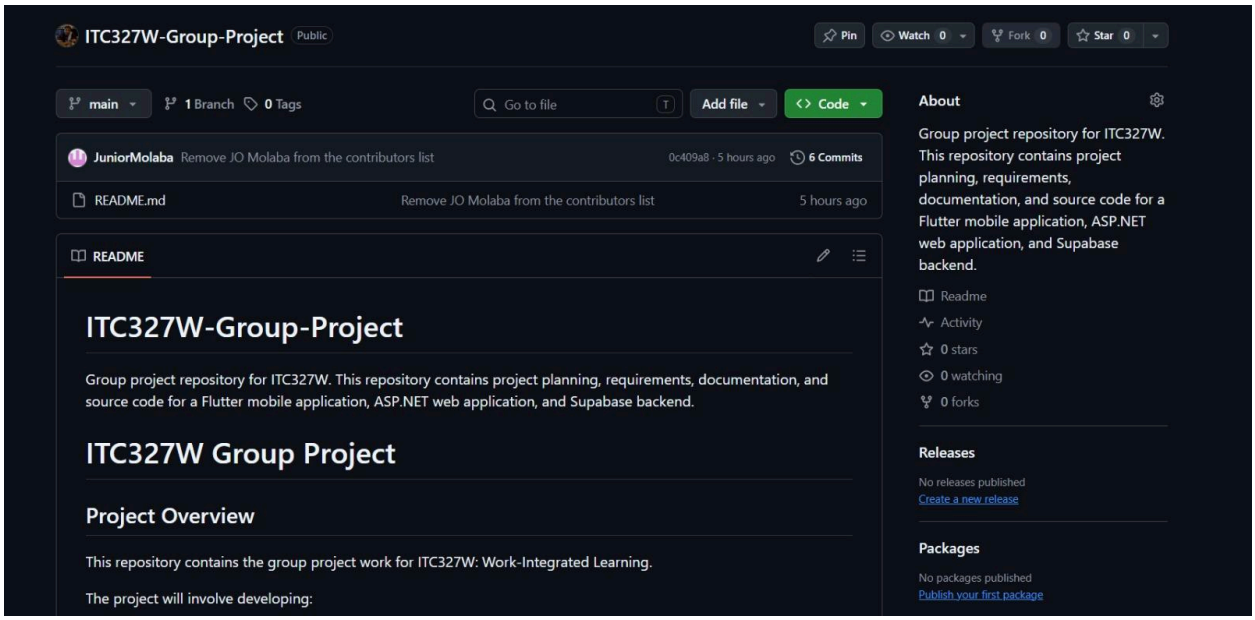
## 14.2 Task Sheet:




| | Task Mode | Task Name | Duration | Start | Finish | Predecessor | Resource Names | Add New Column |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | **Phase 1** | **10 days** | **Tue 26/08/18** | **Mon 26/08/31** | | **Project Team** | |
| 2 | | Project Initiation | 1 day | Tue 26/08/18 | Tue 26/08/18 | | Project Team | |
| 3 | | Identify Stakeholder | 3 days | Wed 26/08/19 | Fri 26/08/21 | 2 | NL Mazibuko | |
| 4 | | Build Microsoft Project Sche | 2 days | Wed 26/08/19 | Thu 26/08/20 | | LW Simelane | |
| 5 | | Github Repository | 1 day | Wed 26/08/26 | Wed 26/08/26 | | NL Mazibuko | |
| 6 | | Supabase | 2 days | Wed 26/08/26 | Thu 26/08/27 | | AL Hadebe | |
| 7 | | **Stakeholder Interview** | **2 days** | **Mon 26/08/24** | **Tue 26/08/25** | | **PA Mabusela(Time Keep** | |
| 8 | | Problem Area Identificati | 1 day | Mon 26/08/24 | Mon 26/08/24 | 3 | AL Hadebe(Facilitator) | |
| 9 | | Requirements Gathering | 1 day | Tue 26/08/25 | Tue 26/08/25 | | MN Dlamini(Requireme | |
| 10 | | Recording Stakeholder fe | 1 day | Tue 26/08/25 | Tue 26/08/25 | | NL Mazibuko(Note Take | |
| 11 | | **Documentation from Stakeh** | **5 days** | **Tue 26/08/25** | **Mon 26/08/31** | **8,9,10** | **Project Team** | |
| 12 | | Stakeholder and Problem | 2 days | Thu 26/08/27 | Fri 26/08/28 | | NL Mazibuko | |
| 13 | | Software Requirements S | 3 days | Wed 26/08/26 | Fri 26/08/28 | | MN Dlamini,PA Mabusel | |
| 14 | | Project Risk Register | 1 day | Wed 26/08/26 | Wed 26/08/26 | | L Sandi | |
| 15 | | Non-Function, System & I | 1 day | Thu 26/08/27 | Thu 26/08/27 | | NP Khotle | |
| 16 | | Project Progress Checker | 5 days | Tue 26/08/25 | Sat 26/08/29 | | JO Molaba | |
| 17 | | **Feasibility Evaluation** | **4 days** | **Wed 26/08/26** | **Mon 26/08/31** | **13,14** | **M Lesenyelo** | |
| 18 | | Technical Feasibility | 1 day | Wed 26/08/26 | Wed 26/08/26 | | | |
| 19 | | Operational Feasibility | 1 day | Wed 26/08/26 | Wed 26/08/26 | | | |

# 15.GITHUB REPOSITORY EVIDENCE

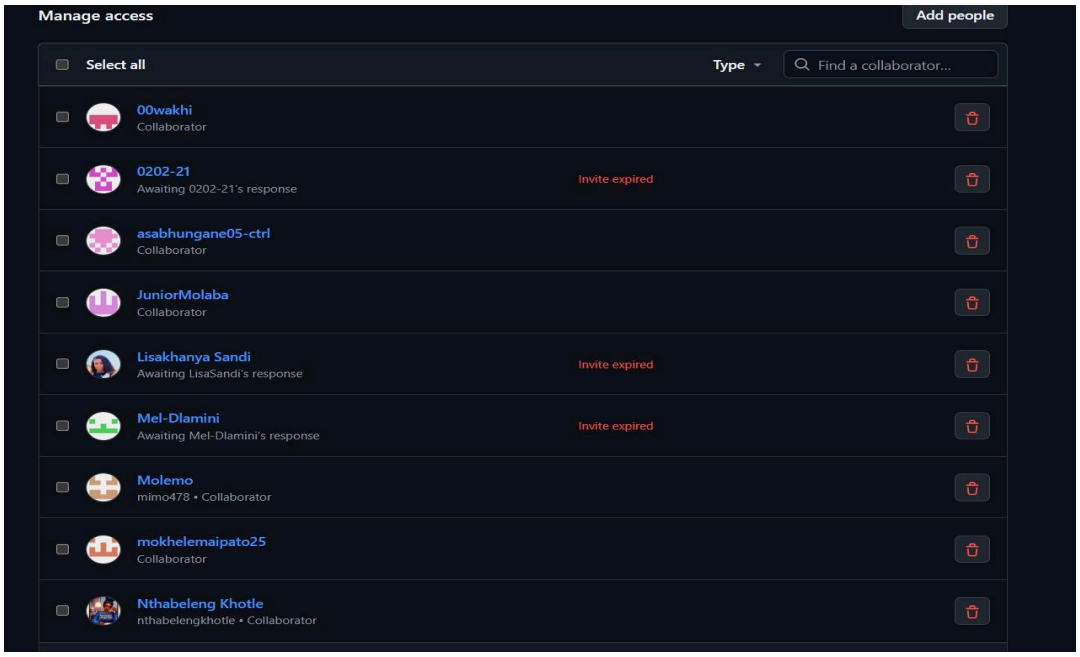
### 15.1 Repository Home Page:




### 15.2 Repository link:

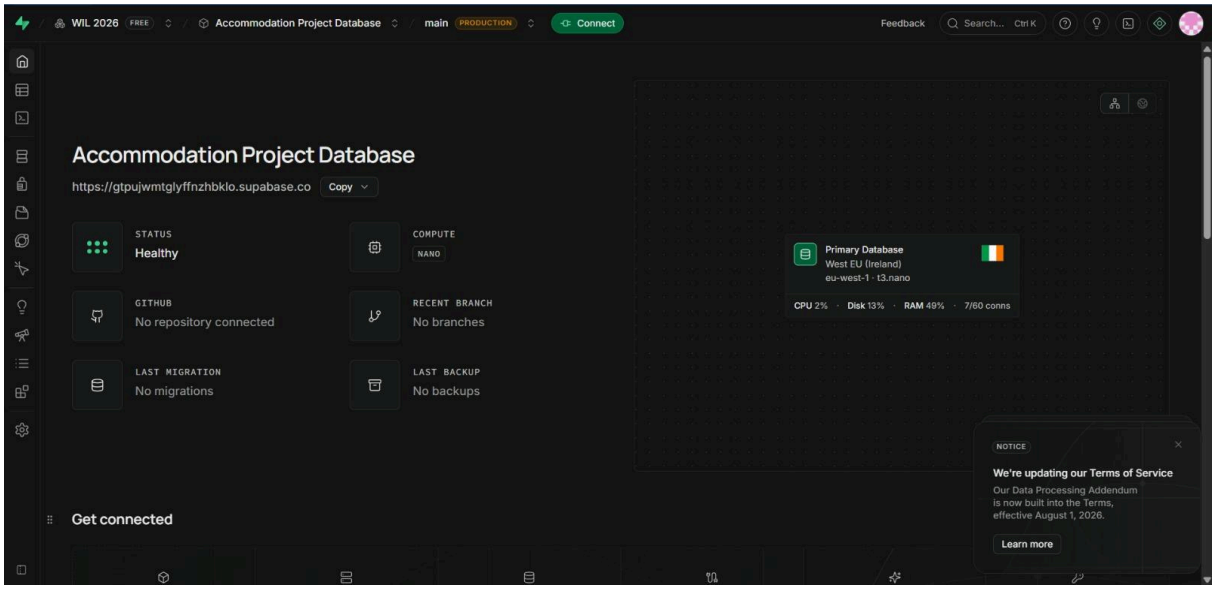
https://github.com/NhlanhlayethuMazibuko/ITC327W-Group-Project.git

### 15.3 Team Members/Collaborators:



# 16. SUPABASE EVIDENCE

**Supabase Project dashboard:**




# 17. GROUP REFLECTION

**Most important learning from this phase:**

The group learned the importance of understanding the stakeholder's actual problem and current processes before designing a software solution.

**What went well and why:**

The group successfully identified Big Brother Accommodation as the stakeholder, conducted stakeholder engagement, gathered requirements and identified the main challenges with the current manual accommodation process.

**What was difficult and why:**

Finding a suitable external stakeholder was initially difficult. The stakeholder also took some time to respond to requests, which delayed requirements gathering and stakeholder engagement activities.

**How were tasks divided among members?:**

Tasks were divided according to assigned responsibilities, including stakeholder engagement, requirements, feasibility and risk analysis, documentation, scheduling, GitHub/Supabase setup and progress tracking.

**Did all members contribute fairly? Explain:**

Yes. Members contributed fairly by respecting their assigned roles and providing the work and deliverables they were expected to complete.

**How did the group handle disagreements or delays?:**

The group communicated through the WhatsApp group, followed up on outstanding tasks and adjusted responsibilities or timelines where necessary. Stakeholder-response delays were managed through follow-ups and by using the information already provided by the stakeholder.

**What did the group learn from the stakeholder?:**

The group learned that the accommodation business currently relies heavily on physical viewing, word-of-mouth and WhatsApp-based advertising, while bookings and payments are largely handled manually. The stakeholder also highlighted the need for easier access to accommodation information, applications and bookings, better management of student information and protection against accommodation scams.

**Improvement action 1 for the next phase:**

Ensure that every member records completed work, dates and supporting evidence in the progress tracker as the work is completed.

**Improvement action 2 for the next phase:**

Confirm and review requirements with the stakeholder before moving into design and development to ensure that the proposed system remains aligned with the stakeholder's actual needs.

**Priority for the next phase:**

Finalise and validate the requirements and project scope, then prepare the system design based on the stakeholder's confirmed needs.